We furthermore presented four indicators to analyse India's policy along the spectrum of balancing and bandwagoning; external security alignment, internal defence policies, economic cooperation, and diplomatic measures. We need to look at the combined effect of all four indicators to classify India's policy towards China. However, of the four indicators, the external security alignment and defence policy indicators have the highest explanatory value, followed by the degree of economic cooperation and then various diplomatic initiatives. In the following, we will present the main findings in this volume on each of these indicators, enabling us to assess India's response to China's rise.

External security alignment

India has neither entered into a military alliance with the United States, nor are US or allied troops based in India on a permanent or semi-permanent, or even rotational, basis. Hence, India is not pursuing a policy of strong alignment, which would correspond with the traditional understanding of external balancing. Moreover, India has not yet imported any substantial offensive weapons platforms from the United States, and even their joint military exercises are still on a rather limited scale. Nonetheless, the development of India's relationship with the United States over the last one and a half decades is quite remarkable. The chapters by Prasad and Pant both present the main milestones in the relationship since the early and mid-2000s, and they refer to a number of bilateral agreements between India and the United States that now facilitate expanded cooperation in space, civilian nuclear activities, joint defence industry production, and transfer of technology from the United States to India. The United States has designated India as a